

# The PM Process: Bringing EcoPulse to Life

Building a product like EcoPulse isn't just about writing code; it's about deeply understanding a problem and orchestrating a solution. As the Product Manager, my role is to be the voice of the user, the strategist for the business, and the partner to the engineering team. Here's a look at the thought process and the key decisions that shaped EcoPulse.

## Phase 1: Discovery & Validation

It all started with a hypothesis: *companies and employees want to be more sustainable, but they lack the tools to do it effectively*. To validate this, we needed to talk to real people.

- **The 50+ User Interviews:** We didn't just jump into the building. I spent the first several weeks conducting over 50 interviews with our target personas: employees who care about the environment, and sustainability/HR leaders at mid-to-large sized companies.
  - **What I learned from employees:** They felt a sense of "eco-guilt" but were overwhelmed. They didn't know where to start, and they weren't sure their individual actions made a difference. This highlighted the need for **personalization, actionable recommendations, and a sense of collective impact**.
  - **What I learned from companies:** They are facing real regulatory pressure. Reporting on Scope 3 emissions is a huge, manual headache. They see sustainability as important for their brand and for attracting talent, but they need to prove the **ROI**. This validated the need for a **corporate dashboard with automated reporting and financial insights**.

## Phase 2: Strategy & Prioritization

With our problem and personas validated, the next step was to define the solution. We had a mountain of feature ideas, but we needed to be ruthless in our prioritization to build a successful MVP.

- **Defining the MVP:** The goal of the MVP is to deliver the most value to early adopters with the least amount of effort. For EcoPulse, the core value proposition is the link between employee action and corporate benefit. Therefore, the MVP *had* to include both the employee-facing app and the corporate dashboard.
- **Why the RICE Framework?** I chose the RICE (Reach, Impact, Confidence, Effort) framework for prioritization because it forces us to be objective.
  - **Reach:** How many users will this feature affect?
  - **Impact:** How much will this feature move the needle on our goals?

- **Confidence:** How certain are we about our estimates for reach and impact?
- **Effort:** How much time and resources will this take to build?
- **Key Prioritization Decision:** Gamification (leaderboards, badges) scored high on the RICE framework, even higher than some of the corporate features. Why? Because the user interviews told us that a sense of friendly competition and social validation would be a huge driver of *sustained engagement* for employees. Without employee engagement, the corporate dashboard is useless. This is a classic example of prioritizing a feature that drives the core user loop.

### Phase 3: Design & Execution

- **The Design Process:** We didn't just want a functional product; we wanted a delightful one.
  - **User Flows:** I worked with our designer to map out the key user journeys. For example, "As an employee, I want to track my commute so I can see its carbon impact." We sketched out every step of this process to identify potential friction points.
  - **Wireframes & Prototypes:** We created low-fidelity wireframes to get the basic layout right, then moved to high-fidelity, clickable prototypes. We tested these prototypes with a small group of users from our initial interviews to get feedback before writing a single line of code. This iterative process saved us countless hours of engineering time.
- **Working with Engineering:** As a PM, I'm not the one building the product, but I am responsible for ensuring the team is building the *right* product. This means clear communication and a partnership mentality.
  - **User Stories:** I translated the features from the PRD into detailed user stories for the engineering team. A user story is a simple, powerful tool that frames the work from the user's perspective (e.g., "As a user, I want to log in with my company email so that I can access my account securely.>").
  - **Agile Development:** We work in two-week sprints. At the beginning of each sprint, we plan what we'll work on. At the end, we review what we've built. This agile process allows us to be flexible and adapt to new information.

### Phase 4: Go-to-Market & Beyond

- **Pricing Strategy:** The decision to go with a tiered, per-employee pricing model was intentional. It allows us to serve companies of different sizes and to grow our revenue as our clients grow. We priced it to ensure that the ROI for our customers would be a no-brainer.
- **The 6-Month Roadmap:** The roadmap isn't set in stone; it's a statement of intent. It communicates our vision for the future and helps us to stay focused. The three

release milestones are designed to deliver value incrementally, allowing us to learn and adapt as we go.

- **Measuring Success:** We'll be tracking our KPIs (MAU, carbon reduction %, etc.) obsessively from day one. This data will be our guide for future iterations and will help us to prove the value of EcoPulse to our customers and investors.

Being a Product Manager is about being the ultimate champion for both the user and the business. It's a constant balancing act, but by following a structured process of discovery, strategy, and execution, we can turn a powerful idea like EcoPulse into a world-changing product.